

30 Years

Ingrid and Owen

SINCE NOVEMBER 22, 1996

For Mom and Dad, on thirty years.

Dad raided the shoebox in the hall closet and the album in the basement. Toby rounded up the notes in the back. I put it all together, mostly on the train.

All dates are Dad's best guess from the backs of the prints.

Happy anniversary. We love you.

Maren and Toby

NOVEMBER 22, 1996

The wedding



Cutting the cake.



The wedding party at Minnehaha Falls.

1997 AND 1998

Just the two of you



First canoe trip, Gunflint Trail. July 1997.



The first apartment, in Seward. October 1997.



Mom at Gooseberry Falls. August 1998.

DECEMBER 1998



Christmas at the farm, 1998.

And then there was Maren.

MARCH 1999

She would like it noted that she has been in charge ever since.

MARCH 1999



Maren, two days old. March 1999.

DECEMBER 1999



Maren's first Christmas. December 1999.

The 2000s

2000 TO 2009

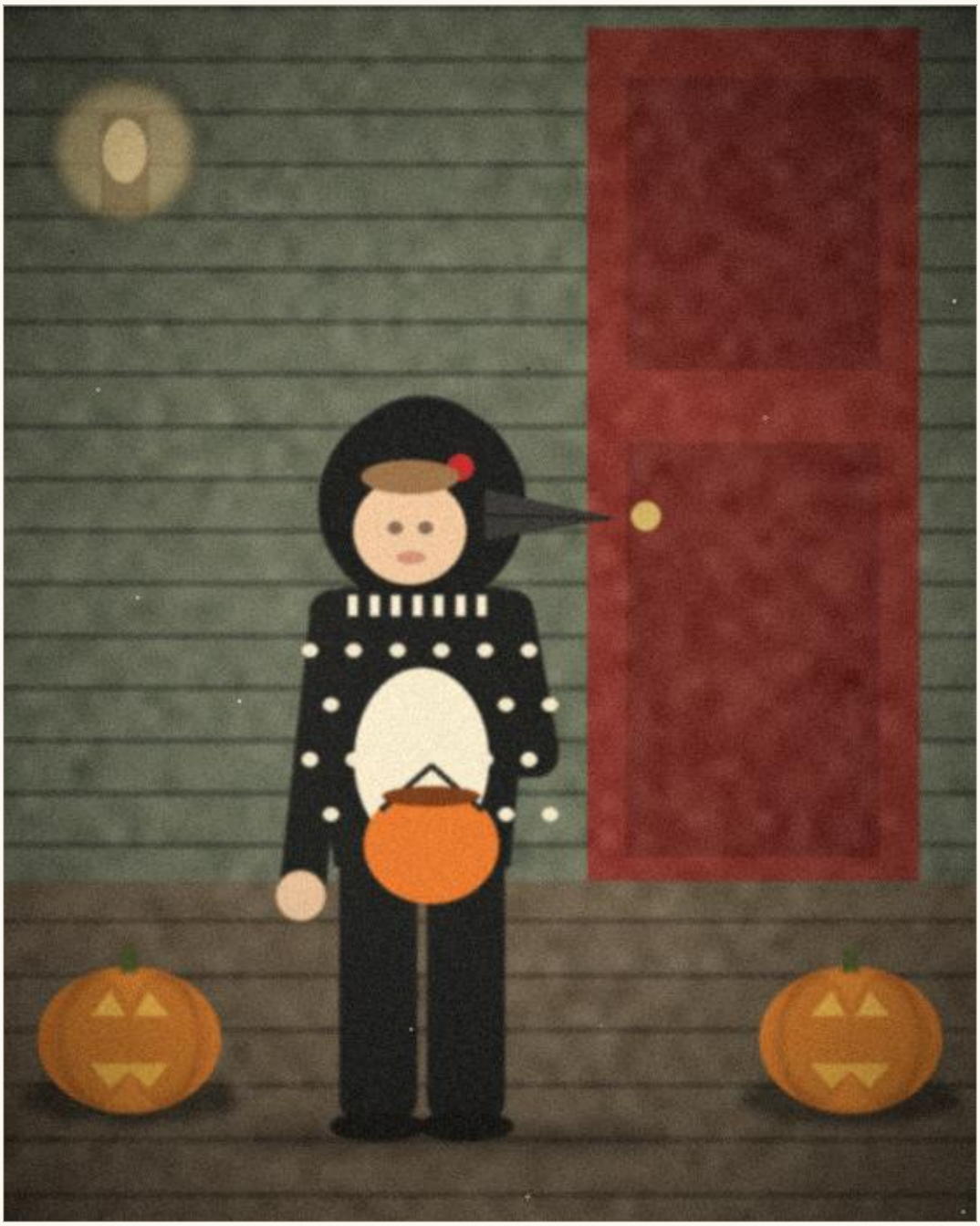
A new century, a house on 34th Avenue, and one more Brandt.

JUNE 2000



Maren at Lake Nokomis beach. June 2000.

OCTOBER 2000



Halloween 2000: Maren the loon, in the costume Dad made.

2001

34th Avenue



Moving day on 34th Avenue. May 2001.



The State Fair. August 2001.

And then there was Toby.

JULY 2002

Two weeks early, and in a hurry ever since.

SUMMER 2002



Toby, brand new. July 2002.



Maren holding Toby. August 2002.

2003

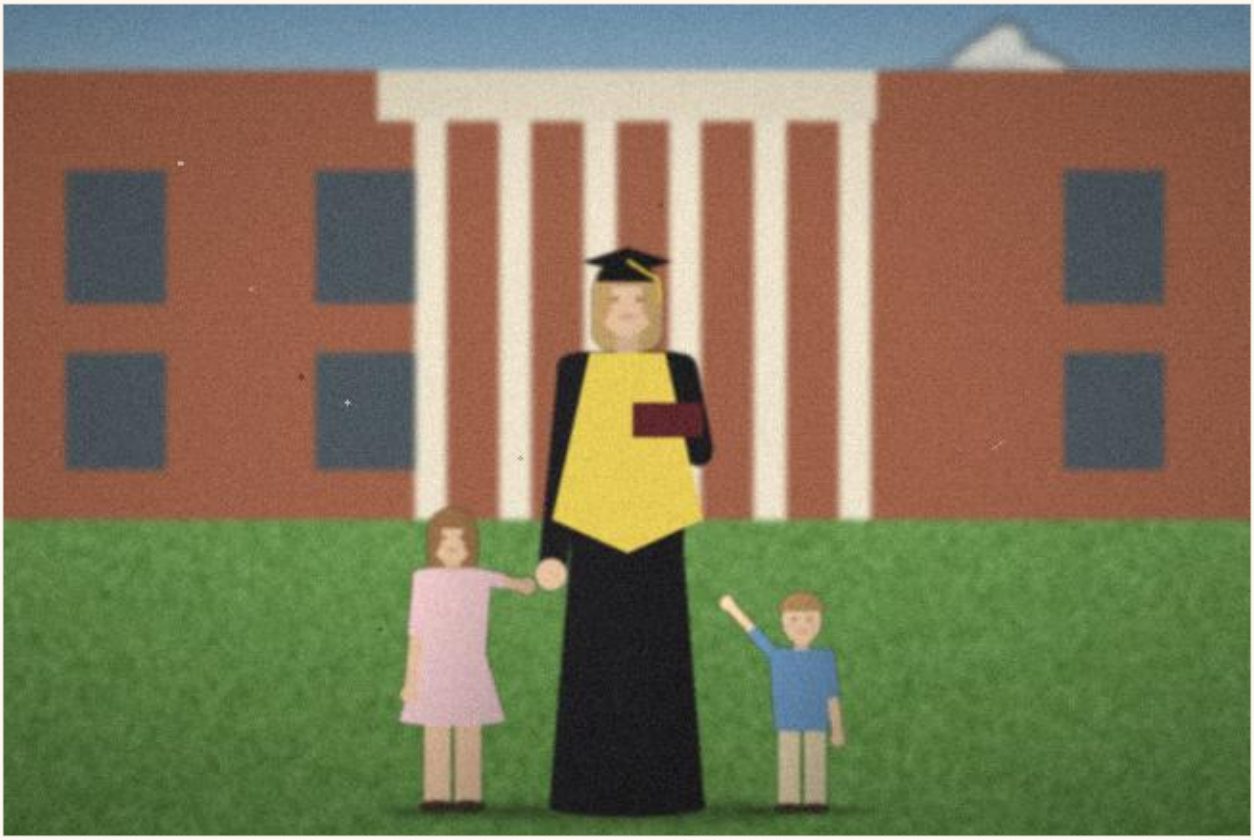


Sledding at Minnehaha Park. January 2003.

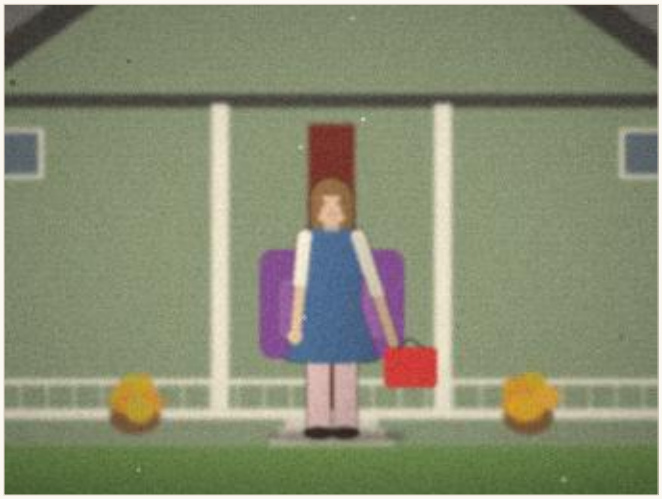


Boundary Waters, July 2003: Mom and Maren in the bow.

2004



Mom's MLIS graduation. June 2004.

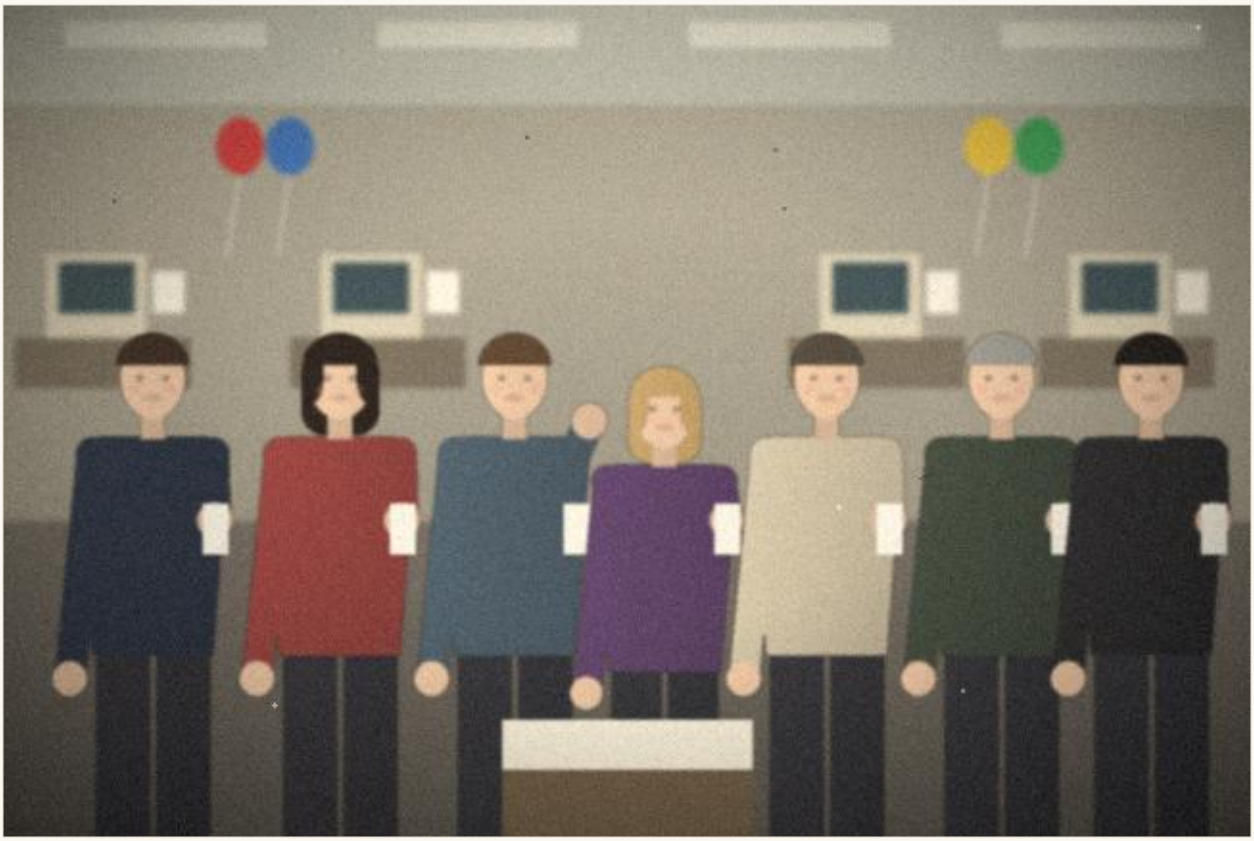


Maren's first day of kindergarten. September 2004.



Mom baking krumkake. December 2004.

2005 AND 2006



The Ledger newsroom party. February 2005.

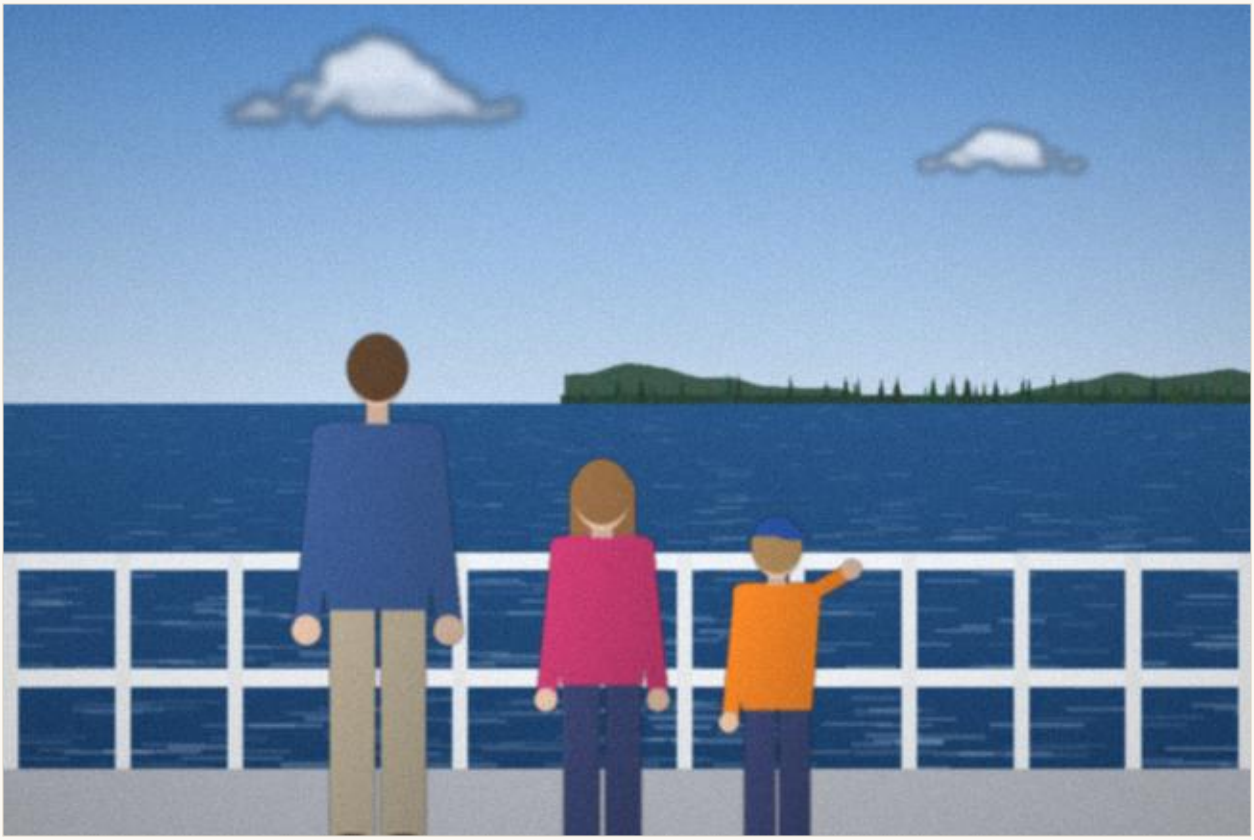


Tettegouche, July 2005: the first family camping trip.

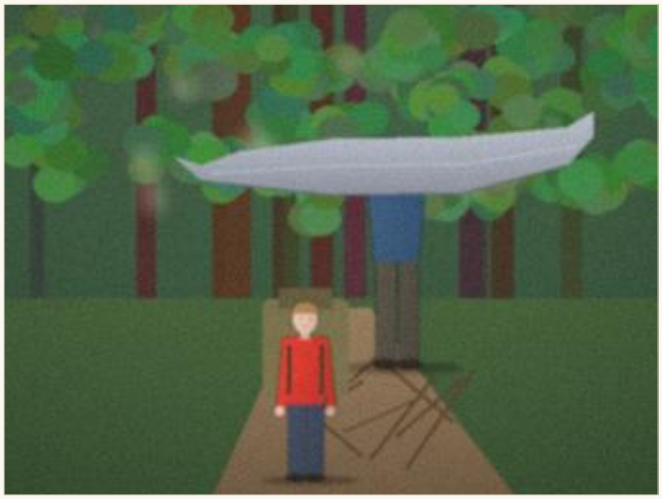


Maren and Toby hunting agates. June 2006.

2007 AND 2008



The Isle Royale ferry. August 2007.

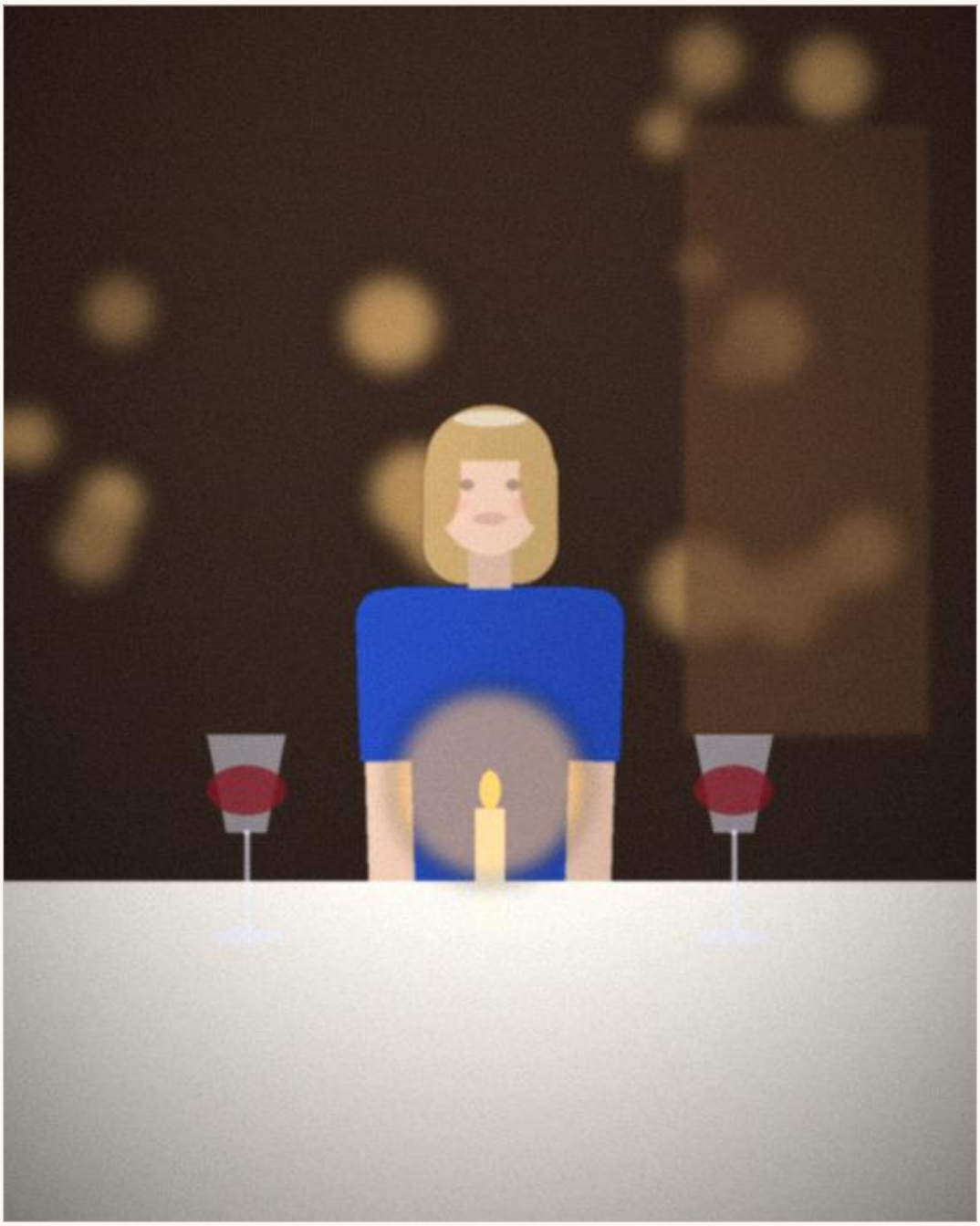


Boundary Waters, July 2008: Toby's first portage.



Same trip: Toby drying out after he fell in.

NOVEMBER 2009



Anniversary dinner, November 2009. Mom in the blue dress.

The 2010s

2010 TO 2019

Grand Marais, the North Shore, a graduation, and a last day at the paper.

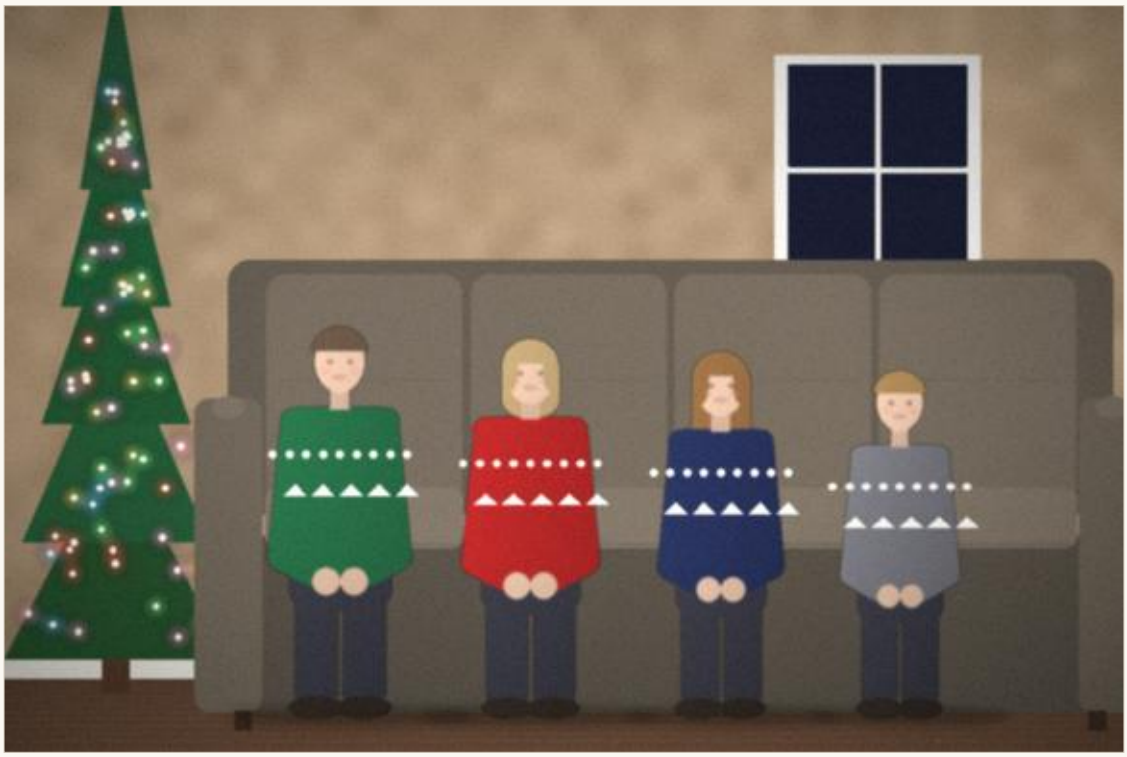
JULY 2010

Grand Marais



Grand Marais harbor, July 2010. All four of us.

2012 AND 2013



Christmas 2012. Everyone in sweaters.



Mom in the river gorge. February 2013.



Superior Hiking Trail near Tofte. August 2014.

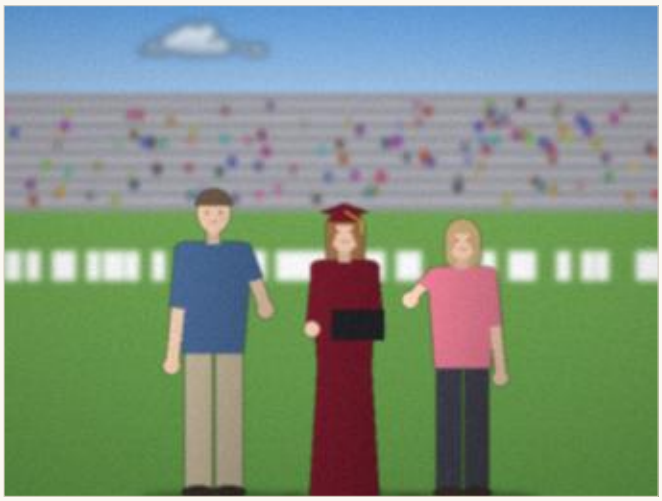


Book fair at Mom's library. October 2015.



Your 20th anniversary, on the North Shore. November 2016.

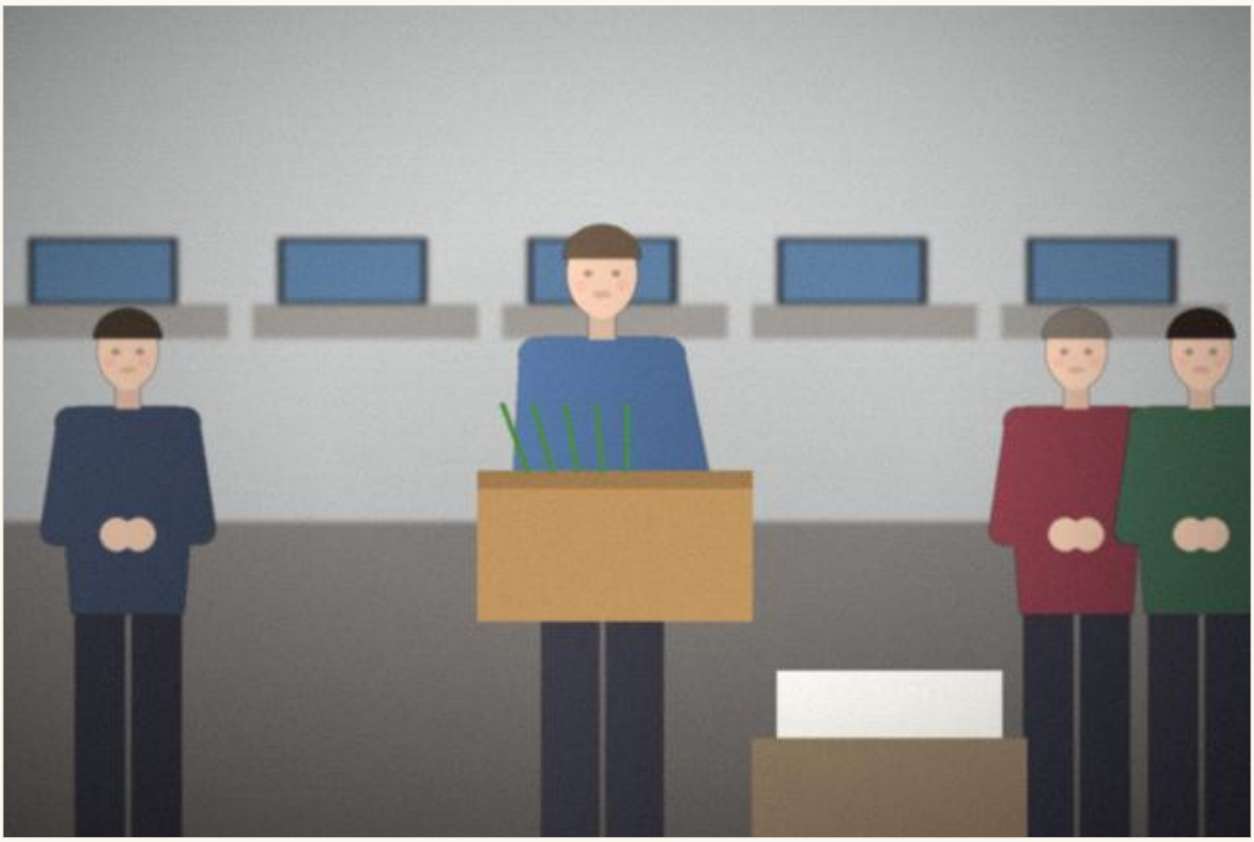
2017 TO 2019



Maren's graduation. June 2017.



Toby's first kayak. July 2018.



Dad's last day at the Ledger. July 2019.

The 2020s

2020 TO 2026

A driveway graduation, a move to Chicago, a trip to Bozeman, and thirty years.

2020 TO 2023



Toby's graduation, driveway edition. June 2020.



Maren's move to Chicago. September 2021.



Visiting Toby in Bozeman. August 2023.

JULY 2026



Tettegouche, July 2026. Mom at the High Falls.

FROM THE FAMILY GROUP CHAT, JULY 12, 2026

Dad: Home from Tettegouche. For the record, your mother out-hiked me on Saturday.

Maren: did u guys make it to the high falls

Mom: We did, and up Mount Baldy too. Nine miles on Saturday, and your father only complained twice.

Dad: Three times. I keep accurate records.

Notes

collected by Toby

i asked everybody who has known you two forever to write something. some of them took it very seriously. grandma's is last because it's the best one.

TOBY

mom and dad. 30 years is wild. thanks for every boundary waters trip, for drying me off in 2008, and for coming all the way out to bozeman. you two are the goal fr. love you.

toby

MAREN

Mom and Dad, I have started this about nine times and cried every time, so this is the short version. Mom, I get books to kids for a living because of you. Dad, I read the footnotes before the headline because of you. Thank you for the canoe trips, the State Fair, and thirty years of showing us how it's done.

P.S. Dad, I am still ahead at cribbage.

Love, Maren

UNCLE KARL

Owen and Ingrid, I stood on those church steps thirty years ago, freezing, and thought my brother had done all right for himself. He still has. Come fishing when the walleye are biting.

Karl

AUNT ASTRID

Ingrid and Owen, Ingrid still calls me after every book fair, and she still talks about Owen like she just met him. Thirty years of that is a gift to all of us. So proud of you both.

Love, Astrid

UNCLE WALT

Owen and Ingrid, your dad would have bragged about the two of you, and about those grandkids, to anyone who would listen. Since he can't, I will. Thirty years!

Uncle Walt

THE COUSINS

Uncle Owen and Aunt Ingrid, thank you for the canoe lessons, the krumkake, and for always letting us stay up too late at your house. You are everybody's favorite. Happy 30th!

Love, the cousins

JOEL OSTRANDER, THE LEDGER

AREA COUPLE MARKS 30 YEARS; SOURCES NOT SURPRISED

MINNEAPOLIS. Owen and Ingrid Brandt will mark thirty years of marriage on Nov. 22, according to everyone who has met them. The groom, reached at his desk, said he would need to check his notes. The bride said she had known since 1996. Film at 11.

-30-

Joel

BEN ARROYO, THE LEDGER PHOTO DESK

owen and ingrid. i have been taking your picture since the ledger days and owen still won't look at the camera. ingrid, the newsroom print in your hallway is yours forever. happy 30.

ben

GRANDMA

Dear ones,

Thirty years ago I stood at the bottom of the church steps in the cold and watched you two come out the door laughing. I have been watching you laugh together ever since, through two babies, a house full of books and more canoe trips than I can count.

Thank you for letting me be part of it.

All my love, Mom

30

Made with love by Maren and Toby

CHICAGO AND BOZEMAN, FALL 2026